SEAT RECLINER HANDLE SPRING REPLACEMENT

AFFECTED VEHICLES: CERTAIN 2001 MODEL YEAR 4-DOOR AND WAGON FOCUS

OVERVIEW

This procedure details the replacement of the seat back recliner handle spring. To perform this procedure, you must deactivate the pretensioners and side air bags. This requires the use of two (2) Side Air Bag/Pretensioner Diagnostic Service Tools (special tool number 418-139).

SERVICE PROCEDURE

WARNING!

WAIT AT LEAST TWO MINUTES AFTER DISCONNECTING THE BATTERY GROUND CABLE BEFORE DISCONNECTING ANY SUPPLEMENTAL RESTRAINT SYSTEM ELECTRICAL CONNECTORS. FAILURE TO FOLLOW THIS WARNING CAN CAUSE PREMATURE DEPLOYMENT AND MAY RESULT IN PERSONAL INJURY.

WARNING!

DO NOT USE RADIO KEY CODE SAVERS WHEN WORKING ON THE SUPPLEMENTAL RESTRAINT SYSTEM. FAILURE TO FOLLOW THIS WARNING CAN CAUSE PREMATURE DEPLOYMENT AND MAY RESULT IN PERSONAL INJURY.

WARNING!

ALWAYS WEAR SAFETY GLASSES WHEN WORKING ON AN AIR BAG EQUIPPED VEHICLE AND WHEN HANDLING THE AIR BAG MODULE. IN THE CASE OF PREMATURE DEPLOYMENT, FAILURE TO FOLLOW THIS WARNING MAY RESULT IN PERSONAL INJURY.

WARNING!

NEVER PROBE THE ELECTRICAL CONNECTORS OF AIR BAG MODULES OR ANY OTHER SUPPLEMENTAL RESTRAINT SYSTEM ELECTRICAL CONNECTORS. FAILURE TO FOLLOW THIS WARNING CAN CAUSE PREMATURE DEPLOYMENT AND MAY RESULT IN PERSONAL INJURY.

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1. Prove out the Supplemental Restraint System. For additional information, refer to Section 501-20B Occupant Restraints — Passive: Diagnosis and Testing in the 2001 Focus Workshop Manual.
2. **Turn the ignition switch to the OFF position and remove the key from the ignition switch.**
3. **WARNING: TO AVOID ACCIDENTAL DEPLOYMENT AND POSSIBLE PERSONAL INJURY, THE BACKUP POWER SUPPLY MUST BE DEPLETED BEFORE DIAGNOSING, REPAIRING OR INSTALLING ANY FRONT OR SIDE AIR BAG SRS COMPONENTS AND BEFORE INSTALLING, ADJUSTING OR STRIKING COMPONENTS NEAR THE FRONT OR SIDE AIR BAG SENSORS, SUCH AS DOORS, INSTRUMENT PANEL, CONSOLE, DOOR LATCHES, STRIKERS, SEATS AND HOOD LATCHES. THE SIDE AIR BAG SENSORS ARE LOCATED AT OR NEAR THE BASE OF THE B-PILLAR. TO DEPLETE THE BACKUP POWER SUPPLY ENERGY, DISCONNECT THE BATTERY GROUND CABLE AND WAIT AT LEAST TWO MINUTES. FAILURE TO FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS CAN RESULT IN ACCIDENTAL AIR BAG DEPLOYMENT, AND MAY RESULT IN PERSONAL INJURY.**

   Disconnect the battery ground cable and wait at least two minutes.
4. Disconnect the side air bag/pretensioner/belt minder electrical connector located beneath the outboard side of each seat and install a Side Air Bag/Pretensioner Diagnostic Service Tool (418-139) to the harness side of the connector.
5. Move both front seats to their full forward position.
6. Remove the two (2) bolts securing the rear of the seat cushion to the seat frame on each front seat.
7. Move both front seats to their full rearward positions.
8. Remove the two (2) bolts securing the front of the seat cushion to the seat frame on each front seat.

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9. **CAUTION: Do not pinch or deform the side air bag/pretensioner/belt minder wiring harness during seat cushion positioning.**

   Position the driver seat cushion to gain access to the seat recliner handle spring. **DO NOT** remove the wire harness from the seat cushion. See Figure 1.

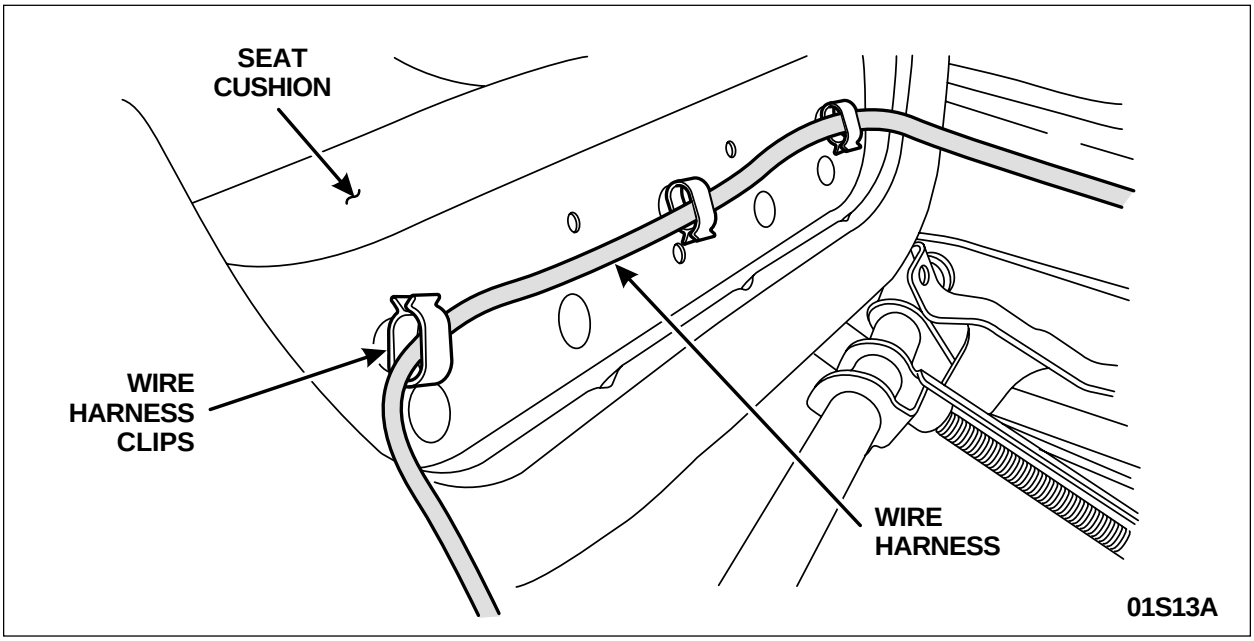


FIGURE 1

10. Remove the seat recliner handle spring from the driver seat assembly. See Figure 2.

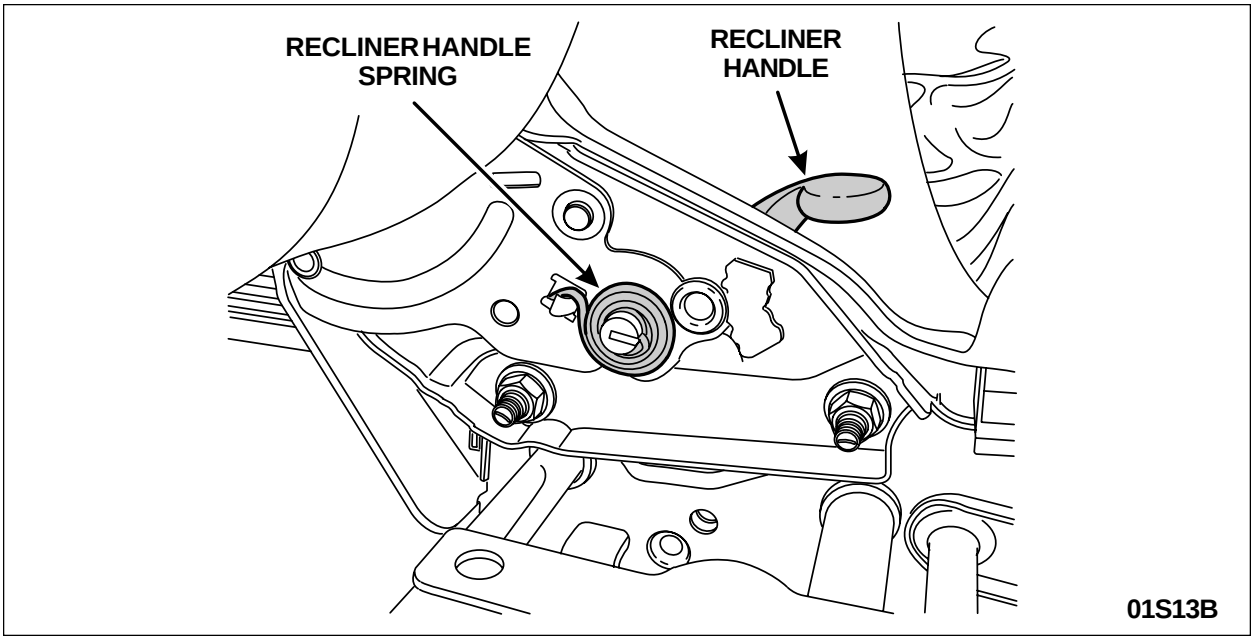


FIGURE 2

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11. Install the ***new*** seat recliner handle spring onto the driver seat assembly. Make sure to align the ***new*** seat recliner handle spring with the hook portion pointing down as shown. See Figure 3.

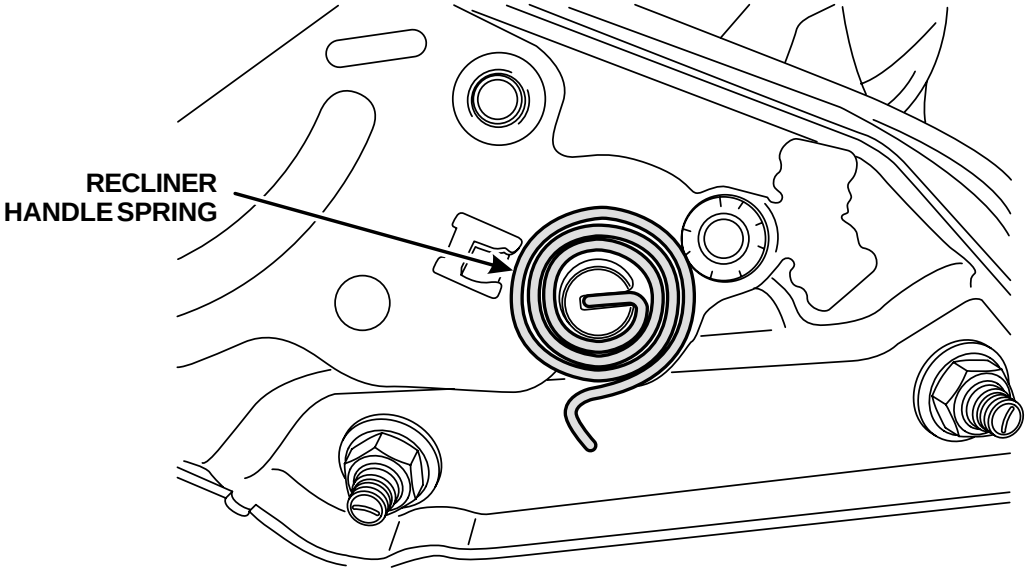


FIGURE 3

12. **CAUTION: Do not pinch or deform the side air bag/pretensioner/belt minder wiring harness during the seat cushion installation.**

    Position the driver seat cushion and wire harness back to their original positions on the driver seat assembly.

13. Repeat steps 9 through 12 for the passenger seat assembly.

14. **CAUTION: Before installing the cushion bolts, physically inspect the air bag/pretensioner/ belt minder wire harness attached to the seat cushions to make sure it is not pinched and can move freely in the harness clips.**

    Install the two (2) bolts securing the front of the seat cushion to the seat frame on each front seat. Tighten the bolts to 28 Nm (21 lb-ft).

15. Move both front seats to their full forward positions.

16. Install the two (2) bolts securing the rear of the seat cushion to the seat frame on each front seat. Tighten the bolts to 28 Nm (21 lb-ft).

17. Move both front seats to their full rearward position.

18. Remove the Side Air Bag/Pretensioner Diagnostic Service Tool (418-139) from the harness side of the side air bag/pretensioner/belt minder connector and connect the electrical connector on both seats.

19. Connect the battery ground cable.

20. With all diagnostic service tools removed and all electrical connectors connected, prove out the Supplemental Restraint System. For additional information, refer to Section 501-20B Occupant Restraints — Passive: Diagnosis and Testing in the 2001 Focus Workshop Manual.

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